



b. 1967 · co-founder of LinkedIn, partner at Greylock.

"Prioritise speed over efficiency to win."

THE WHY THAT DROVE THE WORK

Hoffman asked how companies win markets with winner-takes-most dynamics, concluding that under certain conditions speed should be prioritised over efficiency.

INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

From founding LinkedIn and investing across Silicon Valley, he codified the practice of rapid scaling in the face of uncertainty.

FRAMEWORKS ANCHORED IN THIS COURSE

He anchors the Blitzscaling Lens in Unit 7's scaling Slibrary.

HOW THE IDEAS OPERATIONALISE

Blitzscaling operationalises as deliberately accepting inefficiency and risk to capture a market before rivals, when network effects or first-scaler advantages apply.

LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUE

Blitzscaling is risky and context-dependent; applied where its conditions do not hold, it produces fragile, cash-burning companies.

ENDURING IMPACT

Blitzscaling named and popularised a distinctive Silicon Valley scaling strategy, widely debated among founders and investors.

ON THE SAME PANEL (UNIT 7)

Peter Thiel · Giant 18

Geoffrey Moore · Giant 30

Sangeet Choudary · Giant 31

Sara Blakely · Giant 32

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Hoffman, R. and Yeh, C. (2018) Blitzscaling. New York: Currency.

Sullivan, T. (2016) 'Blitzscaling', Harvard Business Review, 94(4).